

Basic "Hello World" HTML Cheat Sheet

1. Create a new private repository and clone it.

On GitHub, create a new repository (e.g. name it hello-world). Then use your chosen tool to clone it onto your computer.

Remember: "Cloning" means downloading your own copy of the project, kept in sync with the one on GitHub.

2. Open the project in VS Code and write your first line of code.

Open the project folder in VS Code (Visual Studio Code). Create a new file named exactly index.html.

HTML (HyperText Markup Language) describes the structure and meaning of content using nested tags like <h1> or <p>. It doesn't control how anything looks; that's a separate language called CSS, which is not covered in this course (but of course you can still use it in Phase 3).

In index.html, paste in:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>

<h1>Hello World</h1>

</body>
</html>
```

The <body> tag holds everything that actually shows up on the page like text, images, buttons, anything a visitor sees or interacts with. Right now it just contains one heading.

Remember: index.html is the file a browser looks for first when it opens a folder as a website.

3. Open it in your browser.

Find the file in your file explorer / Finder and double-click it. This should open index.html in your default browser and show "Hello World".

4. Commit and push/publish your first change.

In your chosen Git tool, stage the new file, write a short commit message (e.g. "Add hello world"), commit, and push.

Refresh the repository page on GitHub. Your file should now show up there too.

Remember: A commit is a saved snapshot of your project with a note about what changed; pushing uploads that snapshot to GitHub.

5. Add the head section

The `<head>` section holds information about the page itself, not content that gets displayed. You can think of it as notes for the browser (and for search engines), rather than something a visitor sees.

`<meta charset="UTF-8">` tells the browser which character encoding to use, so special characters (like ä, é, or emoji) display correctly.

`<title>Hello World</title>` sets the text shown in the browser tab, and the name used for the page in bookmarks or search results.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>

<meta charset="UTF-8">
<title>Hello World</title>

</head>
<body>
<h1>Hello World</h1>
</body>
</html>
```

6. Commit and Push again

A clean commit history helps your future self understand your project.

Exercise

Do a web search to figure out how to add a Paragraph underneath the title and write something.
Commit and Push.